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Transcripción de audio

IELTS Academic · Set 15

01 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 1: Pedido a una empresa de catering

Agent: Good afternoon, Greenfield Catering. How can I help you?

Customer: Hello. I'd like to arrange catering for an event I'm organising. My first name's Rebecca.

Agent: Of course. Could I take your surname as well?

Customer: Yes, it's Hartley - that's H-A-R-T-L-E-Y.

Agent: Before we start entering details, I should explain how I handle a catering order. I will establish the essential details first, then compare the practical options, and finally read the record back. That gives us a chance to correct a misunderstanding before anything is confirmed.

Customer: That approach works well for me for the catering order. I made some notes beforehand, although I was not sure whether every detail I found still applied, so I would rather verify it during this conversation.

Agent: Thank you, Ms Hartley. And a contact number in case we need to reach you on the day?

Customer: It's 07946 218530.

Agent: Let me read that back to you - 07946 218530.

Customer: For this catering order, I am trying to balance cost with convenience. I need to understand what the standard arrangement includes and what would count as an optional extra, because changing plans later could be inconvenient.

Agent: Of course. In this catering order, I will separate firm conditions from optional features, and you can stop me whenever two alternatives sound too similar.

Customer: That's exactly right.

Agent: Now, what sort of event is it? A wedding, perhaps?

Customer: No, nothing like that. It's a retirement party for my father - he's finishing work after forty years.

Agent: A catering order can involve names, dates and choices that need to be compared rather than heard in isolation. I will therefore use the full wording and repeat any number in a separate group. Please ask immediately if something conflicts with your notes.

Customer: I will. For the catering order, that will help me make a considered decision, especially because I may need to coordinate this with another commitment.

Agent: How lovely. And when is the event taking place?

Customer: It's on Saturday the fourteenth of September.

Agent: September - got it. And roughly how many guests are you expecting?

Customer: Well, I first thought around 50, but a few people can't come now, so let's say 45.

Agent: Let me finish the catering order by summarising what I have recorded. For this catering order, I will review the choices in their final form, spell any unusual word, and explain what happens next. The summary closes the catering order, so even a minor correction is worth making now.

Customer: Good. During the catering order, I will listen carefully and interrupt if anything sounds different.

Agent: 45 it is. And do you have a venue booked already?

Customer: Yes, we've hired the Maple Hall on the high street.

Agent: I know it well. Are there any special dietary requirements?

Customer: Before we close the catering order, could you tell me how I should raise a question after today? I would prefer not to repeat the whole enquiry if one detail changes.

Agent: Certainly. Keep the reference on the confirmation and quote it when you contact us. A colleague can then see the agreed record, identify the single point that needs attention and explain whether the change affects anything else.

Customer: Yes - several of the guests don't eat meat, so we'll need some vegetarian options.

Agent: No problem; we cater for that regularly. Now, let me describe our menus. Our Classic menu offers 3 dishes per person and costs £22 a head, and it includes freshly brewed coffee at the end of the meal.

Customer: That sounds reasonable. What's the other option?

Agent: Before I close this catering order, I will separate the details we have confirmed from the points that remain optional. Please listen to the complete summary before responding, because correcting one item can sometimes affect a later choice as well. I will keep the original order so that it is easy to compare with your notes.

Customer: That is helpful. I will check each detail as you read it and ask about anything that does not match what I intended. Once the summary is accurate, I will also note the reference and the method for making a later amendment.

Agent: The Deluxe menu has 5 dishes and works out at £35 per person. With that one, we also provide a celebration cake, which would suit a retirement party nicely.

Customer: Oh, the cake would be perfect. I think we'll choose the Deluxe.

Agent: Excellent choice. I'll email a written confirmation to you shortly.

02 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 2: Feria de clubes universitarios

Good morning, everyone, and a warm welcome to this year's university clubs fair. My name's Daniel, and I'm the student union's activities officer. Over the next hour I'll take you through what's on offer and how to get involved. Before describing the individual features of this university clubs fair, it is useful to understand the overall sequence. The information for the university clubs fair follows the order in which most people encounter the site or activity, following the main route before considering possible variations. Knowing that sequence will make the later directions and choices in the university clubs fair easier to follow. We currently run more than sixty clubs, and I'll highlight a few of the most popular.

The debating society is one of our largest, and I'm pleased to say it still has plenty of places available, so you can sign up today. The photography club, sadly, filled up within a week, so it's closed for now. If mountaineering appeals to you, do put your name down, but be aware there's a waiting list at the moment. The chess club, on the other hand, has spaces free and would love more beginners. And the drama society is thriving, though you'll need to attend an audition before you can join. Some arrangements connected with the university clubs fair may depend on the time of day or the number of visitors. During the university clubs fair, listen for the difference between a permanent feature and something available only at a stated time.

Where a condition in the university clubs fair is fixed, it will be presented as a rule; where there is flexibility, it will be described as a recommendation. Now, how do you actually join? For most clubs, you simply add your name to the sheet at the registration desk, which is just behind me near the entrance. Membership isn't expensive - the annual fee used to be £20, but this year we've reduced it to £15. Once you've paid, every new member receives a free welcome pack containing a diary, a badge, and some vouchers. As the university clubs fair continues, staff may direct different groups along slightly different routes. Within the university clubs fair, a change to a minor detail does not necessarily alter the main programme.

If an alternative becomes necessary during the university clubs fair, wait for the full announcement before moving, because the first place mentioned may be the one that is no longer available. If you're not sure which club suits you, don't worry. Taster sessions are completely free for the first two weeks of term, so you can try several before committing. Do not try to memorise every detail of the university clubs fair at once. The key locations and decisions will be repeated in context. For now, concentrate on where the activity begins, which direction or sequence applies, and the point at which you may need to make a choice or ask a member of staff. I should also mention our biggest social event. Each year we hold a quiz night, which is enormous fun and open to all members.

This year it takes place in the main hall, and tickets go quickly, so book early. A final way to follow the university clubs fair is to separate descriptive information from an instruction that requires action. General advice supports the visit, while a firm instruction must be followed. Keeping those functions separate will prevent an interesting detail from being mistaken for a change to the programme. Finally, a couple of practical points. For a full and up-to-date list of every club, please check the noticeboard outside the union office rather than relying on last year's leaflet. And do remember to

bring your student card to every session, as you'll need it to sign in.

If you become uncertain during the university clubs fair, pause at the next staffed point rather than following another group without checking. Explain the last location or instruction you clearly remember, and staff can reconnect you with the correct sequence. This is especially important when two activities begin near one another or when a temporary diversion changes only one section of the route. The programme is designed to allow questions, so asking for clarification will not make you miss the main activity.

03 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 3: Diseño de una encuesta educativa

Tutor: So, James, Priya - let's talk about the education survey you're designing. Remind me what you're hoping to find out.

Priya: Well, originally we wanted to compare different teaching methods, but that felt too broad. So we've narrowed it down to finding out how much time students spend on homework each week.

Tutor: Before we settle on an interpretation for the education survey, we should separate what the evidence actually shows from what we expected to find. Our first idea may still help organise the work, but it should not decide how we describe the result.

Priya: Agreed. For the education survey, we can distinguish the central finding from our early assumptions. That will make the argument more credible.

Tutor: That's a much more manageable focus. And who are you planning to survey?

James: We considered surveying the whole school, but that's over a thousand students. So we've decided to concentrate on Year 9 only - that's a single year group of about a hundred and twenty.

Priya: We also need to be careful about cause and association in the education survey. Two patterns can occur together without one necessarily producing the other, particularly when the sample is small, participants select themselves, or an uncontrolled factor affects both.

Tutor: Yes. A cautious conclusion is better than an unsupported causal claim.

Tutor: Sensible. A focused sample is easier to analyse. Now, how will you actually collect the data? Paper questionnaires?

Tutor: Another question is whether our categories for the education survey are precise enough for somebody else to repeat the procedure. We know what we intended because we designed it, but a reader only has the written definition.

Priya: For the education survey, let us test the instructions on somebody outside the group. That should reveal any ambiguity before the final version.

Priya: We debated that. Paper is simple, but entering all the responses by hand would take ages. So we're going to use an online form instead - the results come in already digitised.

Tutor: Good thinking. What worries you most about the design?

Priya: The order of the education survey presentation matters as much as the individual sections. If we give every technical detail before explaining the central question, the audience may lose the thread.

Tutor: For the education survey, we can introduce the question, present only the method needed for the finding, and move secondary detail to an appendix.

James: Honestly, our biggest concern is that students might exaggerate. When you ask people about homework, they tend to overstate how much they do, so the figures may not be reliable.

Tutor: That's a very real risk with self-reported data. One way to reduce it is to keep the questionnaire anonymous, so students feel no pressure to impress. I'd strongly recommend that.

Tutor: Our final review of the education survey should use the agreed criteria rather than simply whether we like the finished version. We need consistent terminology, evidence for each claim and a conclusion that answers the question without exaggeration.

Priya: I will turn those points into a checklist. Then we can compare our independent checks and revise only where they reveal a problem.

Priya: We hadn't thought of making it anonymous. That's a great idea.

Priya: We should keep a note of any decision we change during the final review of the education survey, including the reason for it.

Tutor: Agreed. That record will stop us from reopening settled points without new evidence, and it will show which revision corrected a real weakness rather than merely changing the wording.

Tutor: Now, let me suggest a clear process. First, before you send it to everyone, run a small pilot with just a few students to check the questions make sense. Second, once you've collected the responses, you'll need to code the data so it can be analysed statistically. Then look for patterns - for instance, whether older students report more homework. After that, write up your findings, and finally, present your conclusions to the class.

James: That's really helpful. We'll start with the pilot next week.

Tutor: Before we finish the education survey, let us read the argument from the perspective of somebody who did not collect the evidence. Each claim should identify what was observed, how it was measured and which limitation affects the interpretation.

Priya: I will also check that our recommendation follows from the result rather than from what we expected at the beginning. If a sentence sounds stronger than the method allows, we can narrow it without losing the main point.

Tutor: Good. Then the final version will show a clear line from the research question through the evidence to the conclusion.

Tutor: Excellent. Send me the draft questions first.

04 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 4: Blanqueamiento de corales

Today I'd like to talk about one of the most striking phenomena in marine biology: coral bleaching. To understand it, we first need to understand what coral actually is. To place the coral-bleaching lecture in perspective, we need to distinguish the familiar modern description from the longer process that produced it. Within the coral-bleaching lecture, what now appears stable often emerged through several pathways rather than one smooth sequence. A simple list of events in the coral-bleaching lecture can hide those alternatives, so the discussion will emphasise why particular changes mattered. Although a coral reef looks like rock, it is in fact built by colonies of tiny animals called polyps.

Each polyp secretes a hard skeleton of calcium carbonate, and over thousands of years these skeletons accumulate to form the vast structures we call reefs. Evidence for the coral-bleaching lecture does not come from a single source. Researchers may compare historical material with evidence gathered using modern instruments. Each source answers a different question and carries its own uncertainty. Agreement can increase confidence, while disagreement often reveals an assumption or a measurement problem that deserves closer examination. What makes coral so remarkable is a partnership. Living inside the tissues of each polyp are microscopic algae. Through photosynthesis, these algae provide the coral with food - in fact, up to ninety percent of the coral's energy comes from them. In return, the coral offers the algae shelter. The algae also give the coral its brilliant colour; the reds, greens and browns we associate with healthy reefs come almost entirely from them. Scale is especially important when evaluating the coral-bleaching lecture. A process observed in one case, one community or one short trial may behave differently across a region or over several generations. In this coral-bleaching lecture, the lecture will return to this distinction in each case study. This comparison helps identify which conditions are essential and which are merely helpful. So what is bleaching? Bleaching occurs when the coral becomes stressed and expels the algae living within it. The most common trigger is a rise in sea temperature.

Corals are surprisingly sensitive: an increase of just one or two degrees, if it persists for several weeks, is enough to break down the partnership. When the algae are gone, the coral loses its colour and turns a ghostly white - hence the term "bleaching". It is also worth noticing the language of certainty used in the coral-bleaching lecture. Some mechanisms are supported by direct observation, while others remain the best explanation available from indirect evidence. Scientific caution does not mean that every account is equally likely. Keep that distinction in mind as the examples are brought together. It's important to understand that a bleached coral is not yet dead. It is simply under severe stress, and if conditions improve quickly, the algae can return and the coral may recover.

But if the stress continues, the coral will starve and die. The separate examples in the coral-bleaching lecture can finally be organised around three questions: what conditions begin a change, which mechanisms sustain it, and what consequences appear later. For the coral-bleaching lecture, it also makes similarities visible without pretending that every case is identical. The conclusion to the coral-bleaching lecture will use that framework to connect the details without extending them beyond the available evidence. Warming water is not the only threat. Pollution from

the land, and the rising acidity of the ocean as it absorbs carbon dioxide, both weaken corals further. This matters because reefs support a quarter of all marine species and protect vulnerable coastlines from storms and erosion.

A useful final check is to ask what observation would make the present account of the coral-bleaching lecture less convincing. Identifying such evidence keeps the explanation testable and reveals where future research would be most informative. It also prevents a plausible narrative from being treated as complete merely because its separate examples fit together. There is, however, hope. Around the world, scientists are now growing young corals in underwater nurseries and replanting them on damaged reefs. One final point about the coral-bleaching lecture concerns the difference between a useful model and a complete explanation. A model selects the relationships that matter most for a particular question, so it can be informative even when it leaves out local variation.

Problems arise when that simplification is forgotten and a result from one scale is treated as a rule for every case. The evidence discussed here should therefore be read with its conditions attached: the period observed, the population or material studied, the method used and the uncertainty that remains. Those conditions do not weaken the account; they show exactly where the conclusion is supported and where further observation would be needed.